# MODULE F

## Human Resources

C&A 101

MODULE F.1

# Reporting a Conduct Concern

## CONFIDENTIALITY AND REPORTING

Clubs must maintain confidentiality for personal information about their members, including any conduct, personal challenges, etc. However, there are limits to confidentiality as a club/club member of the Students' Union. Club Members are obligated to complete the **Student's Union Reporting Form** under certain conditions. When they have received information or observed actions pertaining to the health, safety and conduct of their peers.

**This includes but is not limited to**:

- Disclosures of gendered and sexual violence
- Instances involving actions contrary to the values of equity, diversity and inclusion (EDI)
- Instances where you are concerned for the wellbeing of a peer
- Conduct contrary to Club and Association Policy/Procedures or the non-academic student code of conduct.

When receiving this type of information from a student directly, the individual must be advised of the limits of confidentiality and club members' obligation to follow the reporting process.

**If submitting a form, do not share information with other club members/the general public.**
**Information should go up (to the SU through the form), not out (to others).**
**The Clubs and Associations department will follow-up with appropriate action.**

## Types of Reporting

- **Disclosure of Gendered Sexual Violence**
  - If you receive a current or historical disclosure of gendered and/or sexual violence you must inform the Students' Union so that they can provide support and resources to the student(s) should they need it.

- **Student of Concern**
  - If you receive information or observe behaviour that makes you concerned for the potential well-being of another student, you must inform the Students' Union so that they can provide support and resources to the student(s) should they need it.
  - **Student wellness concerns** include but are not limited to mental health concerns, self-harm concerns, threat/harm to others, marked changes in mood or behaviour, difficulty in communicating and/or distortions of reality or learning or academic challenges beyond what is normal for a University student.

- **Club Member Conduct**
  - If you receive information or observe behaviour in another Club Member that is contrary to the policies and procedures of the Students' Union and/or the Non-Academic Student Code of Conduct you must inform the Students' Union so that they can appropriately follow up with the individuals involved.

**Rule of Thumb: When you observe club-related conduct, fill out the Student's Union Reporting Form first and foremost and the department will follow up with the involved parties accordingly.**

**DO NOT take action unless advised or approved by the VP Clubs & Associations.**

MODULE F.2

# LEADERSHIP EXPECTATIONS

## RESPONSIBILITIES

- It is your responsibility to ensure that you, your club and its members are following all Laurier, Students' Union, Clubs & Associations and other applicable policies
- As a leader in your club, you are also a leader in the Laurier community and the broader Kitchener-Waterloo community
- You represent you club, the university, the Students' Union and your club members when you interact with others; your actions should reflect positively on those you represent
- It is your responsibility to foster a positive and welcoming environment within your club and the broader community
- You are expected to wield your power with humility and not to exert it over others

## INTERACTING WITH THE COMMUNITY

- When you are interacting with **the community** (your club, students, Students' Union staff, venues, etc.), it is expected that you treat community members with respect, including all communications via email, call or meeting
- Remember that each person you are interacting with is first and foremost a human being; you may not like the rules they are enforcing, but they are doing their jobs
- Remember that you are one of over 200 clubs, in addition to other organizations working with the Students' Union and university administrations; this will affect response times as staff try to help everyone, and repeatedly following up only lengthens that process

MODULE F.2

# HOW TO SUBMIT A LEADERSHIP REPORT

- **Gather context**
  - Before reaching out, make sure you can clearly outline the issue. Try to provide examples, dates, and any attempts you've made to resolve the situation.

- **Email your AVP**
  - Send an email to your assigned AVP explaining:
  - The nature of your concern
  - Specific examples of the President's actions or inactions
  - Names of other executives who may support or be affected by the situation
  - Any proposed next steps or questions you have

- **Next steps**

Your AVP will review the concern and reach out to:

  - Set up individual or group meetings to better understand the situation
  - Provide coaching, mediation, or support
  - In rare cases, work with the SU Clubs & Associations team to determine if leadership restructuring is necessary

- **All Leadership Reports will be handled confidentially and respectfully.**
- **No disciplinary action will be taken without fair review.**
- **We encourage all clubs to address concerns early and work towards collaborative resolutions.**

MODULE F.3

# CSEDI & EDI

# EQUITY, DIVERSITY & INCLUSIVITY CONCERN

If you receive information about or experience an EDI related issue, it is imperative that you **inform the Students' Union** so that they can provide support and resources and follow up appropriately with those involved. EDI related issues include but are not limited to experiences pertaining to discrimination, oppression and identity-based harm (e.g., racism, sexism, ableism, transphobia – harm directed towards somebody based on an aspect of one's identity).

# CSEDI & EDI

## How to Access CSEDI staff and EDI expert

As the Students' Union, we recognize that your club may represent an equity-deserving group (e.g., women, racialized people, people with disabilities, Indigenous Peoples, religious or spiritual groups, and gender or sexual minorities).

SU is committed to providing support to you and encourages you to connect with the Centre for Student Equity, Diversity, and Inclusion (CSEDI) a student-facing office that offers EDI supports in the forms of systems-navigation, training and programming, and student leadership development.

If your club or members would like to connect with CSEDI, please email diversity@wlu.ca and they can provide more info about the ways in which you can access supports and services.

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MODULE F.4

# CSEDI & EDI

## Things to consider when guaging EDI-Related needs:

Your club may be centered around a federally protected identity (e.g., women, racialized people), but not necessarily promote equity, diversity, or inclusion (EDI) as a part of the club mandate,

- Is EDI in your mandate or is the group more of a social opportunity for members of equity deserving groups to connect?
- When planning your events and programming, what equity considerations do you need to think about to create an inclusive event (such as considerations for accessibility, cultural protocols, religious observances/ holidays, etc.?
- Is your club interested in collaborating for such celebrations or events? Does your club have a designated representative for responding to situations of harm (e.g. harassment, discrimination, identity-based harm)
- Would you like support in determining this role/process?
- Does your club have an intentional process for inclusive meetings/events?
- Does your club provide training or educational opportunities for students to engage with EDI content or expertise
- You are seeking support for yourself or someone you know after an experience of oppression-based harm based on identity, such as racial or gender discrimination and not sure what your options are or where to start. (CSEDI works closely with colleagues at the Office of Human Rights and Conflict Management and can facilitate a warm connection and support in accessing their services).
- You are seeking advocacy, systems navigation or support with internal or external institutional processes.
- You are seeking community and would like to be connected to other student leaders passionate about EDI that provide peer support, educational and social opportunities.
- You are seeking education and resources related to student equity, diversity and inclusion (EDI).

MODULE F.4

# CSEDI & EDI

## Inclusive Leadership-Critical Considerations

Below are some questions to reflect on as a student club aspiring to create inclusive and affirming student experiences:

- How do we (re)design a culture in our student club where everyone can thrive in? What would such a club experience look like? What are necessary conditions to make this vision possible?
- What individual and collective leadership practices do we need to develop to make that happen?

Here are some key practices in fostering inclusion and belonging in your student club:

- Creating an environment where club members feel they can safely show up as themselves and can participate in
- Considering how people's lived experiences impact the way they move through the world
- Paying attention to how access to power and privilege impact the way we engage with each other and as leaders
- Cultivating a culture of self-accountability and growth when we make mistakes and/or cause harm
- Holding people with compassion and care